

GFOA Budget Review Checklist

FY2027 Walton County | Attached criteria dated 8/1/2025 | Review: September 8, 2026

A = addressed P = partial / correction needed V = not verified in PDF. References are PDF page numbers (1-133).

All primary questions are mapped below; bracketed numbers refer to gap notes. A is not an official GFOA score.

Community priorities | criteria p. 8

- ☐ Organizational challenges
A 12-14, 27
- ☐ Community challenges
A 12-14
- ☐ Budget response to challenges
A 13, 27-31
- ☐ Results expected this budget year
A 27, 57-91

Value | criteria p. 9

- ☐ Public benefits and services
A 15, 26-31
- ☐ Cost to government / public
P 4, 15, 26, 28 [1]

Long-term outlook | criteria p. 10

- ☐ Future effect of current decisions
P 36, 110-111 [2]
- ☐ Effect on reserves
P 23, 36, 106-111 [2]
- ☐ Expenses deferred to future years
P 36, 38-39 [3]
- ☐ New ongoing spending obligations
P 35-36, 38 [3]
- ☐ Historical trends / future outlook
P 96, 106, 110-111 [2]

Revenue | criteria p. 11

- ☐ Anticipated revenue
P 15, 32, 93-98 [1]
- ☐ Diversity of revenue sources
A 32, 95-98
- ☐ Control over rates and revenue
P 32, 95 [4]
- ☐ Restrictions on revenue uses
P 32, 95, 116-123 [4]
- ☐ Who bears the revenue burden
A 18-19, 32, 95

Personnel | criteria p. 12

- ☐ Total budgeted staff
P 4, 34, 101 [5]
- ☐ Personnel cost change
A 34-35, 101
- ☐ Staffing increases / reductions
P 34, 101 [5]
- ☐ Drivers of personnel costs
P 34-35 [5]

Departments | criteria p. 13

- ☐ Services for each department
A 42-48, 57-91
- ☐ Costs for each department
P 54, 56-91, 99-100 [1]
- ☐ Accountability for results
A 27, 57-91

Programs / services | criteria p. 14

- ☐ Major programs identified
A 28-31
- ☐ Cost of each major program
P 28, 93-100 [1]
- ☐ Program service-level goals
A 29-31, 57-91
- ☐ Alignment with priorities
A 12-13, 27-31
- ☐ Revenue generated by programs
P 29, 57-91 [6]

Capital | criteria p. 15

- ☐ Definition of capital spending
A 37, 113, 116
- ☐ Level of capital spending
P 37, 39, 114-123 [1]
- ☐ Project prioritization
A 38-39, 114-115
- ☐ Capital funding sources
A 38, 113, 116-123
- ☐ New / replacement / rehabilitation
P 38-39, 116-123 [3]
- ☐ Major projects and delivery detail
P 38, 115-123 [3]

Budget process | criteria p. 16

- ☐ How budget is developed
A 20-23
- ☐ Who prepares the budget
A 20-21
- ☐ How priorities are considered
A 12-13, 20, 40
- ☐ When decisions occur
A 20-21, 40
- ☐ When public can participate
A 20-21, 40

Budget document | criteria p. 17

- ☐ Access from government website
V Website evidence needed
- ☐ Organization / contents
A 5-6; PDF bookmarks
- ☐ Prominent budget message
A 3-4, 15
- ☐ Effective graphics and images
A 7-8, 15, 26-40
- ☐ Accessibility compliance
P PDF structure [7]

Budget in brief | criteria p. 18

- ☐ Concise overview
P 15 [1]
- ☐ Relevant budget content
A 15
- ☐ Distribution to residents
V Distribution evidence needed
- ☐ Attractive design
A 15

Other formats | criteria pp. 19-20

- ☐ Website: access; interactivity;
V Separate website review
- ☐ accessibility; timely updates
V Separate website review
- ☐ Video: message; education;
V Linked videos not reviewed
- ☐ local relevance; audience / promotion
V Linked videos not reviewed
- ☐ Other media: tools; effectiveness
V Campaign evidence needed

[1] Reconcile financial totals / scopes. [2] Reconcile forecasts; show reserve classifications and policy target. [3] Identify deferred needs, full project funding, schedules, asset type and annual operating costs. [4] Resolve conflicting revenue restrictions / control labels. [5] Reconcile staffing scopes and personnel percentages. [6] Map revenue and subsidy to each major program. [7] Content-level accessibility tags are missing; remediation and validation needed.